RAJASTHAN

# Tangle Triangle

Party candidate expelled from party? And still contesting on party symbol? It happens only in INDIA....or make that the Congress, in Rajasthan. To rewind the whole sitcom, begin from March 27, the last day for filing nominations for the first phase. The party asked ex-minister Arjun Bamania to contest the tribal seat. When he refused, it asked youth leader Arvind Damore to fill in. And Kapoor Singh came



in for the Bagidora assembly seat bypoll within the LS constituency. But on April 8, the last day to withdraw nominations, the Congress entered into a last-minute deal with the Bharat Adivasi Party, and left both seats for it. But Damore and Singh refused to pull out! Six-year expulsions followed. Now, BAP candidates, fighting under the INDIA banner, will face two Congress renegades fighting under their party symbol—besides the BJP, which too has fielded old Congress hand, ex-minister, ex-MP, ex-CWC man Mahendrajit Malviya! Besides, there are three 'Rajkumars' in the fray. Go figure. ■





**ANANDRAJ YASHWANT AMBEDKAR**
Republican Sena chief, in the race for Amravati, Maharashtra



**PRAKASH AMBEDKAR**
VBA chief, up for Akola, Maharashtra

MAHARASHTRA

# BHIMA'S GRANDSONS

Ambedkar Jayanti, on April 14, saw effusive birthday avowals from across India's polity. It's not only his ideas that are spreading. Three Ambedkar siblings are enlivening the electoral canvas this time. The best-known one, Babasaheb's grandson Prakash Ambedkar, has his Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA) in the thick of action

KERALA

# UNLIKE FATHER

A. **K. Antony**—a.k.a. St Antony. His dad wasn't so christened because of any evangelical zeal; the only thing the Congress veteran spread zealously, almost to a painful degree, was his own USP around an image of pristine purity in politics. His son **Anil**, BJP national secretary and high-profile candidate from Pathanamthitta, must seem on more comfortably familiar ground for a sinning electorate. T.G. Nandakumar—a power-broker known as 'Dallal Nandakumar' (Malayalis like to have two 'l's in 'dalal')—has sprinkled





*Illustrations by* **SIDDHANT JUMDE**